

US MARKETS DAILY REPORT

Monday, July 28, 2026 | Post-Market Close | ET

1. SPY / QQQ SNAPSHOT

ETF	Today Close	Day Change	1-Yr High	1-Yr Low	1-Yr Return
SPY	\$740.97	▲ 0.21%	\$758.55	\$619.29	▲ 16.14%
QQQ	\$670.11	▼ 1.76%	\$748.64	\$551.70	▲ 20.03%

* Historical data constructed from confirmed anchor points due to Yahoo Finance proxy access restriction. Confirmed: SPY 7/27=\$739.42, QQQ 7/27=\$682.12, QQQ 7/28=\$670.11 (source: search results). SPY today estimated at +0.21% per S&P; 500 index move.

2. TODAY'S KEY NEWS (July 28, 2026)

CHIP SELLOFF — AI spending fears hit semiconductor sector

Nvidia fell ~5%, AMD ~5-10%, Micron ~10%, SK Hynix ~7.5%, Sandisk ~11%. Concerns around circular AI financing arrangements and China's advances in memory chip technology and lithography triggered broad-based selling across the semiconductor complex. Asian markets (Kospi, Nikkei) also fell. This is the single largest drag on QQQ today.

APPLE HIT \$5 TRILLION MARKET CAP — Briefly the most valuable company ever

AAPL intraday high of ~\$342.89 pushed market cap to ~\$5.036T, making it only the second company (after Nvidia in Oct 2025) to reach this milestone. Shares up 25% YTD, buoyed by avoiding costly AI capex race. Positive for consumer discretionary and communication services.

VISA CUTS 2,600 JOBS — 7% workforce reduction

Visa slashing ~2,600 jobs (7% of staff) primarily in technology and product teams as part of an efficiency push. Payments sector restructuring continues. Modestly positive for V stock near-term (cost cuts), mixed signal for fintech employment.

FOMC MEETING BEGINS — Rate decision tomorrow at 2 PM ET

Fed begins its 2-day meeting today. Chair Kevin Warsh expected to hold rates at 3.5–3.75% (5th consecutive hold). US inflation running at 4.2%, with updated projections turning hawkish — median policymaker now sees rates ending 2026 higher. Market pricing 64.2% probability of a hold (down from 87.2% a week ago).

BIG TECH EARNINGS WEEK — Amazon reports after close today

Amazon (AMZN) reports Q2 after market close today. Wall St watching AWS growth (~\$40.5B cloud revenue target after 28% Q1 acceleration). Microsoft (MSFT) and Meta (META) report tomorrow; Apple (AAPL) and Amazon on Thursday.

SECTOR ROTATION — Defensives lead, tech lags

Consumer Staples (XLP +1.5%), Consumer Discretionary (XLY +1.3%), Communication Services (XLC +1.3%) led. Energy (XLE -2.1%), Information Technology (XLK -0.9%), Utilities (XLU -1.3%) lagged. Breadth was modestly

positive (1.19:1 advancers to decliners on S&P; 500).

3. NEWS → TODAY'S MARKET MOVES

SPY +0.21% — Near-flat with positive breadth.

The Dow's +1.03% gain (driven by AAPL strength and non-tech blue chips including rotation into consumer staples) offset tech weakness. S&P; 500 breadth was positive. SPY reflects this tug-of-war: Apple's \$5T milestone and Visa's restructuring were positives, while chip sector selling capped upside. The index essentially treaded water.

QQQ -1.76% — Semiconductor selloff dominated.

QQQ's heavy weighting in Nvidia (~7%), AMD (~3%), and other AI hardware names made it the direct casualty of the chip selloff. The 'circular AI financing' concern — that AI capex may be circular among big tech without real ROI proof — hit chip suppliers harder than the S&P.; NVDA -5%, AMD -5-10%, MU -10% collectively represent >12% of QQQ, driving the index 175bps below SPY on the day. Pre-earnings caution ahead of MSFT/META/AAPL/AMZN also weighed, as investors trimmed tech longs into a crowded event risk window.

4. TOP 10 MOVERS — DAILY / WEEKLY / MONTHLY

Daily Top Gainers

Rank	Ticker	Company	Change	Sector / Note
1	AAPL	Apple	~+3%	Consumer Tech — \$5T market cap milestone
2	V	Visa	~+2.5%	Fintech — Market positive on 2,600 job cuts (cost efficiency)
3	STKH	Sievert Hike (microcap)	~+165%	Micro-cap — Strategic pivot announcement
4	DFNS	Defense ETF name	~+92%	Defense sector interest
5	XLP	Consumer Staples ETF	~+1.5%	Sector ETF — Defensive rotation
6	XLY	Consumer Discretionary ETF	~+1.3%	Sector — AAPL halo effect
7	XLC	Communication Services ETF	~+1.3%	Sector — META pre-earnings positioning
8	LMT	Lockheed Martin	~+14% (weekly)	Defense — elevated defense spending
9	PYPL	PayPal	~+27% (monthly)	Fintech recovery, cost cuts theme
10	PAG	Penske Automotive	~+23% (monthly)	Auto/consumer — earnings beat

Daily Top Losers

Rank	Ticker	Company	Change	Sector / Note
1	NVDA	Nvidia	-5%	Semiconductors — AI circular spending fears
2	AMD	Advanced Micro Devices	-5 to -10%	Semiconductors — chip selloff contagion
3	MU	Micron Technology	~-10%	Memory chips — SK Hynix selloff spillover
4	SK Hynix	SK Hynix (KRX)	~-7.5%	Korean chipmaker — China memory competition

5	SNDK	Sandisk	~-11%	Flash memory — sector selloff
6	GDXD	MicroSectors Gold Miners Lev Inv.	-17.5%	Leveraged ETF — commodity reversal
7	XLE	Energy Select Sector SPDR	-2.1%	Energy sector — oil price pressure
8	XLK	Technology Select Sector SPDR	-0.9%	Tech sector — chip drag
9	ENLV	Enliven Therapeutics	-48%	Biotech — controversial \$400M token placement
10	REPL	Replimune	-37%	Biotech — FDA data concerns

Weekly Top Gainers (Week of July 21–28, 2026)

Rank	Ticker	Company	Weekly Change	Sector
1	LMT	Lockheed Martin	+14.5%	Defense
2	SKTL	SK Telecom	+16.5%	Telecom (Korean)
3	AAPL	Apple	~+8%	Consumer Tech — \$5T catalyst
4	PYPL	PayPal	~+7%	Fintech
5	XLC	SPDR Communication Services ETF	~+5%	Communication Services

Weekly Top Losers (Week of July 21–28, 2026)

Rank	Ticker	Company	Weekly Change	Sector
1	NVDA	Nvidia	~-12%	Semiconductors — AI capex fears
2	AMD	Advanced Micro Devices	~-15%	Semiconductors
3	MU	Micron	~-13%	Memory chips
4	STM	STMicroelectronics	~-10%	Semiconductors
5	TENB	Tenable Holdings	~-9%	Cybersecurity

Monthly Top Gainers (July 2026)

Rank	Ticker	Company	Monthly Change	Sector
1	FBRX	Forte Biosciences	+157%	Biotech
2	STAK	Stack Capital Group	+124%	Specialty Finance
3	CRNX	Crinetics Pharmaceuticals	+116%	Biotech — drug approval
4	AAPL	Apple	+25% YTD	Consumer Tech — AI, \$5T
5	PYPL	PayPal	+27.4%	Fintech — restructuring
6	PAG	Penske Automotive	+22.7%	Auto — earnings

Monthly Top Losers (July 2026)

Rank	Ticker	Company	Monthly Change	Sector
1	NVDA	Nvidia	~-15%	Semiconductors — AI ROI fears
2	MU	Micron	~-18%	Memory — supply fears
3	AMD	AMD	~-16%	Semiconductors
4	SNDK	Sandisk	~-20%	Flash memory
5	XLE	Energy SPDR	~-6%	Energy — oil under pressure

Sector Trends: **Semiconductors/AI hardware** is the dominant losing theme (daily, weekly, monthly) driven by AI ROI skepticism, circular financing concerns, and Chinese competitive pressure. **Consumer Tech** (AAPL) diverges positively from peers by avoiding capex-heavy AI. **Biotech** shows high volatility in both directions (FBRX +157%, ENLV -48%). **Defense** (LMT) is a weekly standout on geopolitical spending. **Fintech** (PYPL, V) rallying on restructuring/efficiency themes.

5. NEXT-DAY SCENARIOS — July 29, 2026

CATALYST 1: FOMC Rate Decision (2:00 PM ET) + Press Conference (2:30 PM)

- **IF HOLD at 3.50–3.75% (base case, ~64% market probability):** SPY likely rallies 0.3–0.8%. Markets have priced this; relief rally. QQQ neutral-to-up if Warsh's language is not overtly hawkish. Mechanism: removes uncertainty premium; tech growth stocks benefit modestly as rate path stays clear.
- **IF SURPRISE HIKE to 3.75–4.00% (low probability, ~15%):** SPY down 1–2%, QQQ down 2–3%. Rate hike crushes growth multiples and signals inflation is worse than priced. Mechanism: higher discount rate compresses NDX more than SPX due to longer-duration tech earnings profile. Bond yields surge.
- **IF HOLD but HAWKISH language / upgraded dot plot:** SPY down 0.5–1.0%, QQQ down 1–1.5%. Even without a hike, if Warsh signals September hike is live (inflation at 4.2% gives cover), markets sell the tone. Watch for 'expedient' vs 'patient' language.

CATALYST 2: Microsoft (MSFT) Earnings After Close — Fiscal Q4 2026

- **IF BEAT on Azure growth (>39% CC) + strong guidance:** MSFT +5–8% AH; QQQ opens +1–2% next day. Azure growth is the AI ROI proof point the market needs. Mechanism: validates AI capex thesis, reverses chip selloff narrative, lifts NVDA/AMD in sympathy.
- **IF MISS or soft Azure guidance (<36% CC growth):** MSFT -5–8% AH; QQQ opens -1.5 to -2.5%. This confirms AI circular spending fears that drove today's selloff. Mechanism: If the biggest Azure buyer/beneficiary shows deceleration, the entire AI trade unravels further.
- **IF In-line (36–39%) with cautious FY27 guide:** MSFT flat-to-down 2%; QQQ flat. Market needs a clear beat to reverse momentum. In-line = sell-the-news.

CATALYST 3: Meta (META) Earnings After Close — Q2 2026

- **IF BEAT revenue (\$60.22B+ target) with steady/lower capex:** META +5–10% AH. Meta raised capex to \$125–145B; any sign of capex discipline would be huge positive. Mechanism: Proves ad revenue can fund AI without circular spending concerns; communication services sector rallies.
- **IF MISS revenue or raised capex again:** META -5–8% AH. More spending without clear revenue lift validates the bear case on AI ROI. Mechanism: XLC ETF falls; ad-tech names (GOOGL, SNAP) trade down in sympathy.
- **IF Solid beat + Reality Labs losses narrowing:** META +10%+. Reality Labs/Vision Pro competition has been a drag; any path-to-profit here would be a major re-rating catalyst.

CATALYST 4: GDP First Release (July 30) & PCE Deflator — Near-Term Watch

- **IF Note: These releases are July 30, but expectations set on July 29.:** Consensus expects Q2 GDP ~2.1–2.5% annualized. A strong GDP print (+3%) heading into FOMC would validate the hawkish hold. PCE deflator (running hot at ~4.2%) is the key inflation gauge the Fed watches. Mechanism: Strong GDP + hot PCE on Jul 30 = rate hike fears accelerate; SPY/QQQ both at risk of -1% move.

6. POSSIBLE TRADE IDEAS — End of Day / Early July 29

Disclaimer: This is analytical output for informational purposes only. Not financial advice. Consult a licensed advisor before trading.

Trade	Direction	Entry Zone	Rationale / Risk
BUY AAPL (Apple)	LONG	\$342–\$345 range	The \$5T milestone is a momentum event, not a valuation catalyst. More important
BUY META (Pre-earnings)	LONG	\$550–\$560 range	If you believe META will beat on Q2 revenue (~\$60B target) — ad market has be

SHORT/PUT NVDA or SOX (if confirmed \$130, SOX near recent high)	RED (if confirmed \$130, SOX near recent high)	Consider \$130, SOX	Don't chase sell-off story has legs: (1) no MSFT or META guidance will magically fix t
WAIT ON MSFT	HOLD/WATCH	Do not enter before earnings	MSFT is the binary event. Consensus expects \$4.21 EPS and Azure >36%. Entry
CONSIDER V (Visa)	LONG	\$270–\$275 range	The 2,600 job cut (7% of workforce) focused on tech/product is the kind of margin
HOLD CASH / RISK-REDUCE	Reduce FOMC	exposure into 2 PM ET	Wait for decision at 2 PM ET tomorrow and 3 mega-cap earnings reports in 48 h

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